

AUIB
Society of
Arts and
Letters

SAL - BRD - 01
جمعية الفنون والآداب

Brand & Identity

The Society's design system, version 4:
a new symbol and wordmarks, one hue, two languages

For the Media Director, the Design Lead and anyone making something with the SAL name on it

Prepared by

Shaheen Farjo

Founder & President

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What Changed

Version 3 gave the Society its first written design system. Version 4 keeps its palette, voice and documents, and replaces the mark with one we like better.

AREA	VERSION 3 (SEPTEMBER 28)	VERSION 4 (NOW)
Identity	A round crimson Key with “SAL” in it, and the name typeset beside it	A notched crimson panel (the symbol) and two four-line wordmarks, English and Arabic, drawn as fixed artwork
Colour of the mark	Crimson Key; name in crimson	One hue: crimson symbol, Crimson 700 wordmarks. Reversed: white symbol, Crimson 100 wordmarks
Arabic type	Noto Kufi Arabic	Ubuntu Arabic, Regular and Bold. Never another Arabic face
Colour roles	Palette only	Nine role tokens (surface, text, title, accent-line, band...) that switch between light pages and ink pages
Space and shape	Not written down	Page margin, gaps, card padding, radii and a hairline rule, measured and named
Components	Described in words	Four built components: Document Cover, Document Footer, Form Header, Social Post
Iconography	Icons in cards	No icon set. The symbol is the only picture; we use words

Kept

The AUIB three (crimson, ink, white), the six supporting tones, Ubuntu and Ubuntu Mono, the document parts, the voice, the photography rules.

Retired

The round Key and every lockup built on it. They stay in the archive for reprints of existing material only (page 16).

The source of truth

The design system in Claude, *AUIB Society of Arts and Letters*: tokens, logo files, fonts and components. This guide explains it.

The Symbol

A crimson panel with a V-notch cut into its top: a page, cut like the end of a bookmark ribbon. It is the only picture the Society uses.



sal-symbol.svg · crimson, on light grounds



sal-symbol-white.svg · on crimson or ink



sal-avatar.svg · profile pictures

Why a notch

It reads at once as paper and as a marker: the page we write on and the ribbon that keeps our place. It ties the mark to Waraq, the Typewriter and the Ribbon at every handover, without spelling them out.

Why no letters

The name lives in the wordmarks beside it. The symbol alone stays legible at 6 mm, on a stamp, a badge or a favicon, in either language.

The notch is the unit

Its depth, about a quarter of the symbol's width, sets the gap to the wordmark and the clear space around every lockup.

Use the files; never redraw the shape. The symbol is always crimson on light grounds and white on crimson or ink. It has no outline, gradient or second colour.

The Wordmarks

The name in two languages, each on four lines, drawn once and never retyped.

AUIB
Society of
Arts and
Letters

sal-wordmark-en.svg · “AUIB / Society of / Arts and / Letters”
in Ubuntu Bold, left-aligned

جمعيةُ الفنونِ
والآدابِ في
الجامعةِ
الأمريكيةِ

sal-wordmark-ar.svg · «جمعيةُ الفنونِ / والآدابِ في / الجامعةِ»
«الأمريكيةِ» in Ubuntu Arabic Bold, right-aligned

AUIB
Society of
Arts and
Letters

- Colour is Crimson 700 on light grounds and Crimson 100 on crimson or ink (the *-reversed* files)
- Line breaks, line spacing and proportions are fixed
- Text is outlined in the files, so no fonts are needed to use them

جمعيةُ الفنونِ
والآدابِ في
الجامعةِ
الأمريكيةِ

- Below about 9 px cap height the four lines stop being legible: use the symbol alone
- Never set the wordmark in ink, in crimson, or on one line
- The Arabic wordmark is checked artwork; do not re-break or re-vowel it

Lockups

The symbol and the wordmarks, arranged three ways, each in a light and a reversed file.



Horizontal · symbol + English. The default: covers, letterheads, most things.



Horizontal, reversed · on crimson and ink.



Bilingual · English | symbol | Arabic. For anything public: calls, posters, certificates.



Bilingual, reversed · the Open Call and other ink pages.



Stacked · symbol over English. Square spaces, stickers, merchandise.



Stacked, reversed · merchandise on crimson.

Proportions are built in. In every lockup the symbol stands as tall as the English wordmark, from the first cap line to the last baseline, and the gap between them equals the notch depth. In the stacked lockup the symbol spans the height of the first three lines. Never assemble a lockup by hand.

Clear Space and Misuse



Clear space: one notch depth on every side

Minimum sizes

- Symbol: 6 mm tall printed, 24 px on screen
- Horizontal lockup: 45 mm wide in print
- Wordmarks: about 9 px cap height; below that, the symbol alone

With the University

- Where the AUIB logo appears, it leads; the SAL lockup follows at equal or smaller height
- Follow Student Life's rules on the University's name and marks
- "AUIB Society of Arts and Letters" in full on first use in formal documents

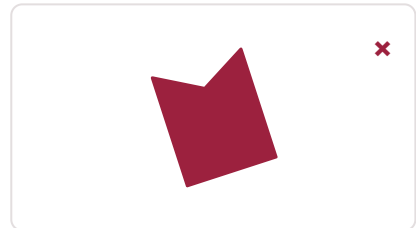
Never



Stretch or squash it



Recolour it: no gold, no gradients



Rotate it



Crimson symbol on ink (1.7 : 1)



Add shadows or effects



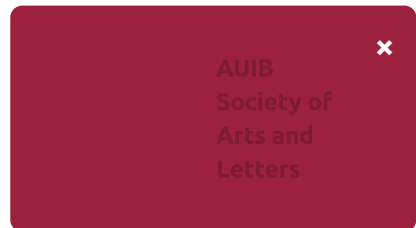
Ink wordmark



Retype or re-break the name



Rebuild a lockup by hand



Put the light files on crimson

Colour

The AUIB three lead; six tones do the quiet work. Never add a colour, and no programme may add one.



Crimson

The symbol, titles, bands. 7.8 : 1 on white.



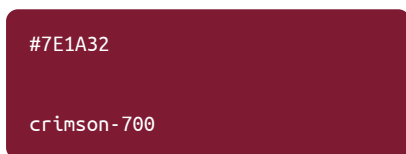
Ink

Text, dark pages, the Open Call. 13.2 : 1 with white.



White

Paper for everything.



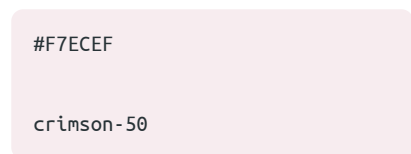
Crimson 700

The wordmarks on light grounds (10.1 : 1); fine print on tint.



Crimson 100

The wordmarks on crimson (5.2 : 1) and ink (8.8 : 1); lines on ink.



Crimson 50

Cards, notes, highlights. Text on it: ink, Ink 70 or crimson.



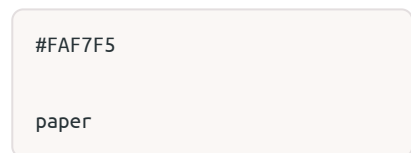
Ink 70

Secondary text on white (7.7 : 1) and tint (6.7 : 1).



Ink 50

Captions and meta only, 8 pt+, on white (4.6 : 1).



Paper

Waraq's warm page only.

The mark is one hue



Light grounds: crimson symbol, Crimson 700 wordmarks. Crimson or ink: white symbol, Crimson 100 wordmarks.

Proportions



About 60% white, 22% crimson, 12% ink, 6% tints. Crimson boldly, but not everywhere.

Colour Roles

Build with roles, not raw colours. Each role has a value for light pages and for ink pages, so one template works on both.

ROLE	LIGHT PAGES	INK PAGES	USE
surface	 white	 ink	Page ground
surface-tint	 crimson-50	 ink-70	Cards and notes
text	 ink	 white	Body and headings
text-secondary	 ink-70	 white	Secondary text
text-meta	 ink-50	 crimson-100	Captions, footers, page numbers (on surface only)
title	 crimson	 white	Display section titles
accent-line	 crimson	 crimson-100	Header rules, table heads, kickers
band	 crimson	 crimson	Full-bleed bands, one per page
on-band	 white	 white	Text on a band (7.8 : 1)

When to use an ink page

- The “why” pages: mission, preamble, the case for the Society
- The Open Call and recruiting
- Never for covers or forms: they are always light
- On ink, titles and text are white; lines and kickers are Crimson 100

Contrast

Crimson on white	7.8 : 1	Any size
Crimson 700 on white	10.1 : 1	The wordmarks; any size
White on ink	13.2 : 1	Any size
Crimson on Crimson 50	6.7 : 1	Any size
Crimson 100 on ink	8.8 : 1	Lines, kickers, reversed wordmarks
Ink 50 on white	4.6 : 1	Captions, 8 pt and up
Ink 50 on Crimson 50 or Paper	4.0 / 4.3 : 1	Fails: use Ink 70
Crimson on ink	1.7 : 1	Never, for text or the symbol

Type

Ubuntu speaks for the Society. Ubuntu Arabic is its Arabic partner. Ubuntu Mono types like the Typewriter.

UBUNTU · ENGLISH

Display 700

Lede 300, one sentence

Heading 700

Body 400 at 10.5 pt, 1.5 leading. Short lines, plain words.

KICKER 700 · TRACKED CAPITALS

SAL-GOV-01 · F-14 · 3.4

Ubuntu Mono: document codes, Form numbers, clause numbers, six-word pages.

UBUNTU ARABIC · العربية

جمعية الفنون

عنوان بالخط العريض

نص بالخط العادي، أكبر بدرجة من الإنجليزية المجاورة،
وبتباعد أسطر أوسع.

Regular 400 and Bold 700 only: Ubuntu Arabic has no Light, so Arabic ledes use Regular. It is not on Google Fonts; it ships with the design system under the Ubuntu Font Licence. Never substitute Noto Kufi or another Arabic face.

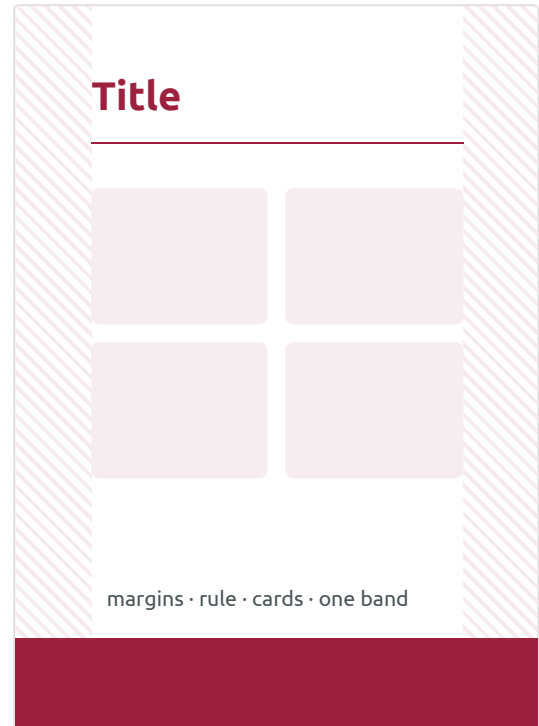
STYLE	A4 (PRINT-*)	POST (POST-*)	WEIGHT · LEADING	ARABIC BESIDE IT (AR-*)
Display	58 pt (range 42–58)	132 px (118–132)	700 · 1.02	ar-display 58 pt · 1.4
Lede	17 pt (14–17)	44 px (36–44)	300 · 1.3	Regular, one step larger
Heading	18 pt (11.5–18)	48 px (28–48)	700	ar-heading 19 pt · 1.8
Body	10.5 pt (9–10.5)	30 px (26–30)	400 · 1.5	ar-body 10 pt+ · 2.0
Caption	8.5 pt (7.5–8.5)	24 px (22–24)	400 · 1.4, text-meta	ar-caption 9 pt · 1.8
Kicker / code	7.8 pt, tracked 0.06em · Mono 9 pt	–	700 · 400	ar-post 32 px on posts

Use the top of each range; go smaller only when the copy demands it. Set `dir="rtl"` and `lang="ar"` on Arabic text.

Space and Shape

Measured from our own pages and named, so every new document sits on the same grid.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
page-margin	21 mm (79 px)	A4 side margins
gap	5 mm (19 px)	Between cards and lockup tiles
gap-tight	4 mm (15 px)	Between swatches and small tiles
card-padding	4.5 mm (17 px)	Inside cards on surface-tint
radius-card	8 px	Cards and notes
radius-swatch	6 px	Swatches and small tiles
hairline	1 px	Table rules; form header rule at 2×



No shadows

The system has none. Depth comes from ground colour: white, tint, crimson, ink.

One band per page

A full-bleed crimson band is the loudest thing we have. Use it once, at most.

Rules, not boxes

Tables use a crimson hairline under the head and grey hairlines between rows, never full grids.

The Family of Programmes

An endorsed family. Each programme may have its own name and title treatment; all of them carry the symbol and the endorsement line.

THE JOURNAL

Waraq

Its own wordmark (ورق / Waraq) and book faces inside; the symbol on the back cover.



a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE SERIES

Side Quest

Its own title card and stop-motion; the symbol in the end credits.



a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE CHARITY DRIVE

Second Chapter

Name in Ubuntu with the partner's name beside it; the symbol on every poster.



a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE POP-UP

Typewriter Tour

Ubuntu Mono headline; the symbol as a stamp on every page.



a Society of Arts and Letters programme

Every programme must

- Use the SAL palette and the Ubuntu family
- Carry the symbol and "a Society of Arts and Letters programme" (Arabic: «من برامج جمعية الفنون والآداب»)
- Tag @auibsal on every post
- Flag working titles until chosen: Waraq, Side Quest

A programme may

- Have its own wordmark, approved by the Media Director
- Use its own handle once it has a year of content
- Use Paper (Waraq), Ubuntu Mono or book faces as its accent
- Never add a colour

Documents

Every Society document is built from the same parts, so a new member can make one that looks like ours on the first try.

Cover

Horizontal lockup top left; document code top right in Ubuntu Mono with the Arabic name; title 58 pt in ink; a one-sentence subtitle in Light; "Prepared by"; a crimson footer band with the date and status. Always light.

Contents

A full-width crimson band with "Contents", then numbered rows ruled in crimson.

Section pages

A one- or two-word title in Display, in **title**; a one-sentence lede; then content. At most one band.

Ink pages

Set the dark theme for the "why" pages. White titles and text; Crimson 100 lines and kickers.

Legal text

Two columns; articles numbered in Ubuntu Mono with a crimson rule; clause numbers in the margin.

Forms

Crimson header rule; form code in Mono; the symbol top right; labels in tracked capitals; ink write-on lines that survive photocopying; a grey office-use strip.

Footers

Every page but the cover: code and title left, "3 / 14" right (spaced slash, no "Page"), 7.5 pt in **text-meta**.

Closing page

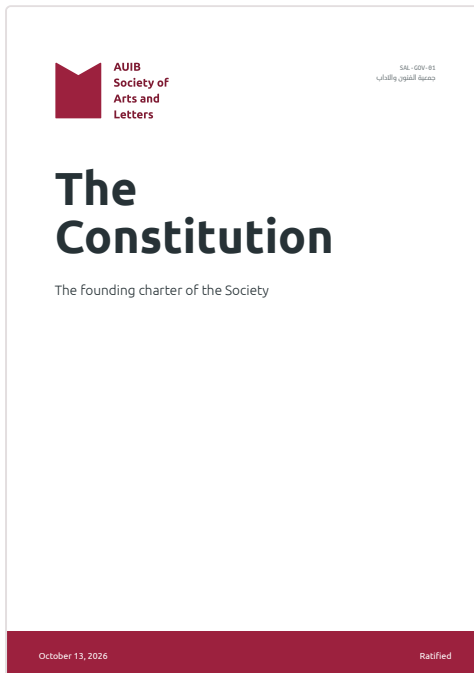
"Thank You." (or a line of our own) in crimson Display, with a crimson footer band.

CODE	SERIES	EXAMPLES
SAL-GOV	Governance	Constitution, Bylaws, Roles & Staffing
SAL-POL	Policies	Policy Manual
SAL-OPS	Operations	Playbook, Templates & Forms
SAL-STR • MEM • BRD • PRT • PRP	Strategy, members, brand, print, proposals	Strategic Plan, Member Handbook, this guide

Components

Four built parts in the design system, in plain HTML with one stylesheet. Copy them; do not rebuild them.

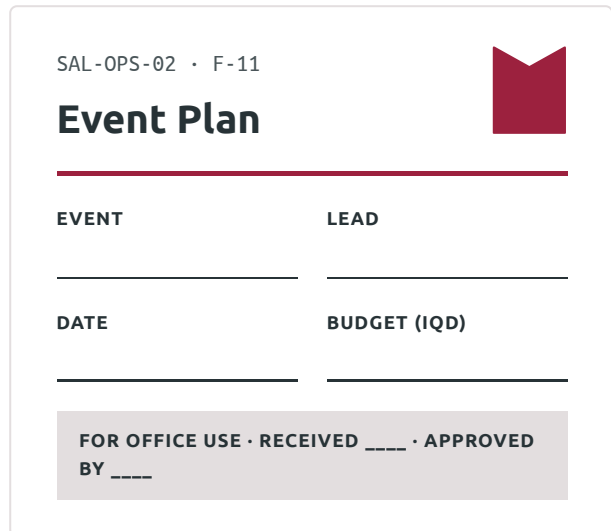
DOCUMENT COVER



Document cover template for AUJIB Society of Arts and Letters. The cover features the organization's logo (a stylized 'M' shape) and name in the top left corner. The title 'The Constitution' is prominently displayed in the center, with the subtitle 'The founding charter of the Society' below it. The document code 'SAL-OPS-02' and the title in Arabic 'مذكرة القانون والفنون' are in the top right corner. The date 'October 13, 2026' and the status 'Ratified' are at the bottom.

The first page of every document. You give it the code, title, subtitle, author, date and status. Always light; no footer.

FORM HEADER



Form header template for an 'Event Plan'. It includes the document code 'SAL-OPS-02 · F-11' and the organization's logo in the top right corner. The title 'Event Plan' is centered. Below the title are four fields: 'EVENT', 'LEAD', 'DATE', and 'BUDGET (IQD)'. At the bottom, there is a section for 'FOR OFFICE USE · RECEIVED ____ · APPROVED BY ____'.

The top of every form, with its field and office-use patterns. Labels are nouns ("Date", "Proposed by"), never questions; money fields give their unit.

DOCUMENT FOOTER

SAL-BRD-01 · Brand & Identity v4

3 / 18

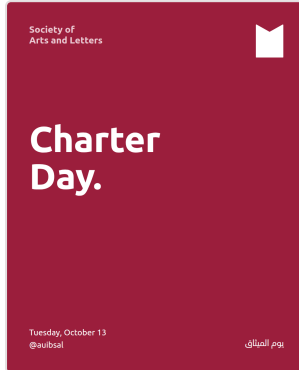
Every page but the cover. Ink pages keep it; there it turns Crimson 100.

SOCIAL POST

The 1080 × 1350 post in four grounds, shown on the next page.

Social and Print

One idea per post; the headline does the work. The ground follows the purpose.



Crimson · calls and moments



Ink · recruiting



White · membership



Tint · regular programmes

Posts (1080 × 1350)

- Society name top left; the symbol top right, white on crimson and ink
- A two- or three-word headline, 132 px, with a full stop
- One line of Arabic, bottom right, on every call (Ubuntu Arabic, 32 px)
- Always the date, always @auibsal; no emoji, no exclamation marks
- The profile picture is *sal-avatar.svg*

Print

- Posters A3/A4, with the symbol and a QR code bottom right
- Term Card A6, four to an A4 sheet
- Membership cards 85 × 55 mm on 300 gsm
- Certificates A4 landscape, double crimson rule, bilingual lockup
- Stickers and merchandise: the stacked lockup

Voice

We sound like a well-read friend: warm, precise and never grand. We look like a page from a good typewriter: white paper, ink, one crimson accent.

WE ARE	WE ARE NOT	SO WE WRITE
Warm	Gushing	"We would love you to join us." Not "An AMAZING opportunity!!!"
Concrete	Vague	"Tuesday, October 13, 4 PM, Room [x]." Not "soon, somewhere on campus."
Confident	Grand	"A journal read blind and printed with care." Not "Iraq's premier literary institution."
Bilingual	Translated as an afterthought	Arabic written for Arabic readers, then checked by a native speaker.
Playful	Mocking	"The worst poem at AUIB wins." Jokes about ideas, never people.

House style

- Short titles: "Charter Day", "Every Dinar", "The Ribbon"
- Dates as "Tuesday, October 13"; times as "6:00 PM"; money as "50,000 IQD"
- Numerals in tables; words in prose under ten
- British spelling in formal documents: organisation, programme, colour
- No emoji; no exclamation marks in headlines

Names and pictures

- "the Society" or "SAL", never "the club"; never "Art and Letter"
- Arabic-named partners in their own language first: Natrok Athar (ناترك اثار)
- No icon set. The symbol is our only picture; use words, not icons or emoji
- Mark wrong examples with a plain "x"

Photography

Our own photos of our own people, taken with consent, always beat stock images.

Shoot

- Hands on typewriter keys, pages, books being handed over
- Readers mid-sentence; full rooms
- Close-ups only with consent
- Natural light; no heavy filters

Never shoot

- Anyone wearing a camera-shy sticker
- Identifiable children, ever
- People praying, in distress or in private moments
- Stock photos of books or typewriters in place of ours

Treat

- Colour natural and slightly warm
- Duotone in crimson or ink for posters and covers
- Crop with room for a headline
- The symbol, white, may sit on a crimson duotone

Keep

- Every event archived within a week in *05 Media*
- Consent log updated with every release (F-17)
- Two copies: the Drive and one offline backup

Retired: the Key

The round SAL Key served from version 3 (September 28, 2026) until this guide. It is retired.



- **Do not use it on anything new:** posts, posters, documents, merchandise
- Keep it only to reprint material that already carries it, until that material is replaced
- The files are in the design system under *Retired*, prefixed v3-
- Replace it with the symbol wherever it appears: avatar, stamps, badges, forms, covers

Still carrying the Key: the September 28 founding documents (Constitution, Bylaws, Roles & Staffing, Policy Manual, Strategic Plan, Playbook, Templates & Forms, Member Handbook, Printables, Founding Proposal) and the four Instagram posts. Update them to the symbol before they are printed or posted.

Files and Templates

Everything lives in the Society's design system, *AUIB Society of Arts and Letters*, with copies in *SAL Drive* › *05 Media* › *Brand*.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
sal-lockup-horizontal(-reversed).svg	Symbol + English; the default
sal-lockup-bilingual(-reversed).svg	English symbol Arabic; anything public
sal-lockup-stacked(-reversed).svg	Symbol over English; stickers, merchandise
sal-symbol.svg · sal-symbol-white.svg	The symbol alone
sal-wordmark-en(-reversed).svg	English wordmark
sal-wordmark-ar(-reversed).svg	Arabic wordmark
sal-avatar.svg	White symbol on a crimson square
UbuntuArabic-Regular / -Bold.woff2	Arabic typeface, shipped with the system
tokens.json · bundle.css	Colour, type, space tokens and the four components

Fonts. Ubuntu and Ubuntu Mono are free from Google Fonts. Ubuntu Arabic is not on Google Fonts: install it from the design system's *fonts* folder. Install all three before editing any template. In Canva, upload the logo SVGs and Ubuntu Arabic to the Brand Kit with the three colours.

DOCUMENT	VERSION	OWNER	APPROVED BY
SAL-BRD-01	4.0 (draft 2)	Media Director	Council

Next review: each September. The current version always lives in *SAL Drive* › *01 Governance*; printed copies may be out of date.

**Thank
You.**